CERNO GLOBUS

FIELD INTELLIGENCE

**Issue 007** Monday, November 9, 2026 · Biweekly, 4 pages

# Home Services

Pest Control · Septic & Sewer · Landscape · Pool · Appliance Repair · Moving

Six trades, one publication. Every item is something that moves a number on your P&L, changes what you must do by law, or changes what parts and labor cost you.

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BACKGROUND SIGNAL
**The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one**

**Read it online**
This issue, and every one before it

MONEY

## Frontdoor's third-quarter revenue rose 6% to $655 million, half from price and half from volume, while claims costs rose $7 million on more service requests per member.

Frontdoor, the home warranty company with about 17,000 contractors in its network, reported on November 5 that third-quarter revenue rose 6% to $655 million from $618 million. The release says growth was 3% from higher realized price and 3% from higher volume. Home warranties grew 1% to 2.14 million, and retention was 79.7%, up from 79.4%.

Contract claims costs rose $7 million, which the release ties to a higher number of service requests per member, including roughly $9 million of unfavorable HVAC weather. It also lists "normal cost inflation across our contractor network, replacement parts and equipment," largely offset by process improvement initiatives. Favorable claims development was $6 million, against $5 million a year earlier.

Net income rose 10% to $116 million and adjusted EBITDA rose 5% to $205 million on a 55% gross margin. Direct-to-consumer first-year revenue fell 1% on promotional pricing, while other revenue rose 32%, mainly from the New HVAC upgrade program. Frontdoor held $581 million of cash at September 30 and completed $259 million of share repurchases through September.

Frontdoor raised its 2026 outlook to revenue of $2.205 billion to $2.215 billion and adjusted EBITDA of $590 million to $600 million. Its board approved a new three-year, $1 billion repurchase authorization on October 30, and it expects to finish the existing $650 million program in November. Full-year assumptions include realized price up about 4% and volume up about 2%.

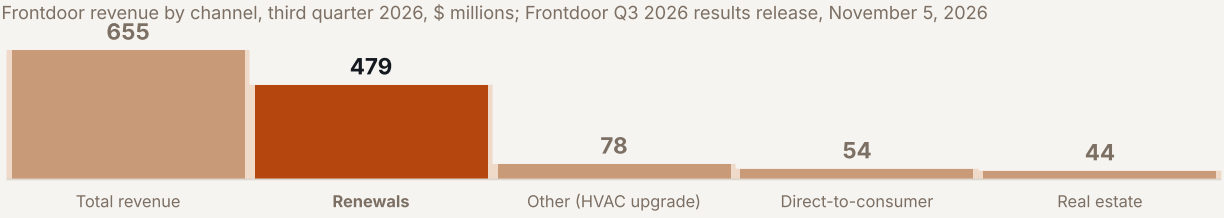
**What to do about it:** If you take dispatch from a home warranty network, pull your last 12 months of its job tickets and compare what it paid per call with your posted rate and parts markup. The release says contractor, parts and equipment inflation was "largely offset by process improvement initiatives," so ask your account contact in writing whether your rates change for 2027. Count how many jobs a month come from warranty dispatch and how many from direct customers, and set a ceiling on warranty share. Check your payment terms and any parts pass-through clause. If you do HVAC work, note that the release counts about $9 million of weather-driven claims in one quarter. Call your three largest warranty accounts before December and ask what service request volume they expect.

Frontdoor Q3 2026 results release (SEC 8-K)

INFOGRAPHIC 1 / WARRANTY REVENUE MIX

### Renewals brought in $479 million of Frontdoor's $655 million third-quarter revenue, against $54 million from direct-to-consumer first-year plans.

Frontdoor revenue by channel, third quarter 2026, $ millions; Frontdoor Q3 2026 results release, November 5, 2026




Renewals rose 4% on higher realized price. Other revenue rose 32%, mainly from the New HVAC upgrade program. Direct-to-consumer first-year revenue fell 1% on promotional pricing, and real estate first-year revenue rose 3%. Ask any warranty network you work for how much of your dispatch volume comes from renewals and when it sets 2027 renewal pricing. Frontdoor Q3 2026 results release (SEC 8-K)

## PEST CONTROL

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

### Golden Gate Capital recapitalized All U Need Pest Control of Fort Myers, Florida, which has more than 50,000 customers and 12 locations in three states, Pest Management Professional reported November 3.

**Why it matters:** Terms were not disclosed. Founder Steve Groeper and CEO Kyle Selbach stay on as shareholders. The company says it grew over eight years through existing markets and new greenfield locations, and sells general pest control, termite prevention, mosquito management and rodent services. Owners in Florida, Texas and South Carolina share markets with a company that now has a private equity owner. Compare your renewal prices and cancellation rates by zip code this week, and put any buyout inquiry in writing.

Golden Gate Capital invests in All U Need (PMP, Nov 3)

LABOR

### NPMA gives every member unlimited postings on its pest control job board, and its November PestWorld issue covers workers' compensation decisions, accommodation requests and employment documentation.

**Why it matters:** NPMA said October 28 that all members get unlimited postings on careers.pestcontroljobs.com, urged companies to keep postings and profiles current through the fall, and pointed to a Workforce Toolkit at NPMAWorkforce.org with sample job descriptions and onboarding materials. On November 2 NPMA said its new PestWorld issue covers workers' compensation claims, accommodation requests and "the paper trail." Post your open technician roles on the board this week, and pull your last three workers' compensation files to confirm each has dated written documentation.

NPMA: Stay Ahead of Your Hiring Needs (Oct 28) · NPMA: PestWorld issue on workers' comp and HR (Nov 2)

## SEPTIC & SEWER

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

### Pumper's November issue, posted November 4, reports that New York's Jefferson County received $550,000 for septic replacements and Seneca County added $300,000 of state money to grants of up to $10,000.

**Why it matters:** Jefferson County's money comes from the state Septic System Replacement Fund and reimburses up to 50% of cost, capped at $10,000, for small business owners and shoreline homeowners near Chaumont Bay, Guffin Bay and the St. Lawrence River. In Lewisboro, the town will form a septic district of nearly 600 properties, using advanced treatment units instead of a planned sewer connection for 300 homes whose cost rose to an estimated $40 million. If you work in these areas, get each program's contractor and invoice rules in writing before you quote.

Pumper: States Expand Septic Repair Grants (Nov 4)

MONEY

### Pitt County, North Carolina, will receive a $250,000 Clean Water State Revolving Fund loan for decentralized wastewater systems, and a Charleston, South Carolina, program will fund repairs for low-income homeowners, Pumper reported November 4.

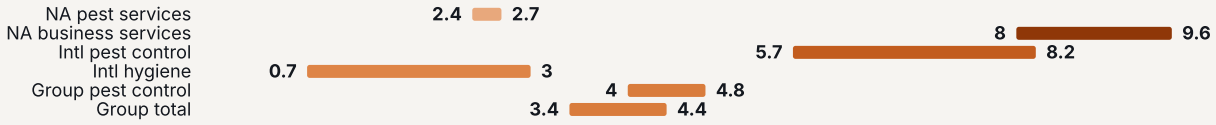
**Why it matters:** The Pitt County loan comes through the Decentralized Wastewater Treatment Systems Pilot Program, part of a $244 million state fund for water and sewer systems. In the Charleston-North Charleston area, Mount Pleasant Waterworks and Charleston Waterkeeper launched a repair assistance program for low-income homeowners, funded by the Coastal Community Foundation's Healthy Harbor Grant Fund. Call the Pitt County and Mount Pleasant program administrators this week, ask whether contractors must pre-register, and get the answer in writing.

Pumper: States Expand Septic Repair Grants (Nov 4)

INFOGRAPHIC 2 / RENTOKIL GROWTH GAP

### Rentokil's North American pest services grew between 2.4% and 2.7% in the third quarter, against 5.7% to 8.2% for its international pest business.

Q3 2026 revenue growth, %; each bar spans a line's organic and reported growth; Rentokil Initial trading update, released October 22, 2026




Reported growth is at actual exchange rates and counts acquired businesses; organic growth excludes businesses acquired during the year. Rentokil ties the 2.4% in North American pest services to residential growth in core pest control and termite and better national accounts growth. North American hygiene, down 1.0% organically, is left off. Compare your own third-quarter route revenue with these lines. Rentokil Initial Q3 2026 trading update (SEC 6-K)

## LANDSCAPE

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

### Scotts Miracle-Gro's U.S. Consumer net sales rose 1% to $3,017.6 million in fiscal 2026 but fell 10% to $279.2 million in the fourth quarter, the company reported November 4.

**Why it matters:** Scotts' total fiscal 2026 net sales were $3,288.9 million, up 1%, and fourth-quarter net sales fell 11% to $302.9 million from $340.1 million. Ask your fertilizer and control-product suppliers for spring 2027 pricing in writing, and price your lawn program renewals against it before you mail them.

Scotts Miracle-Gro FY2026 results release (Nov 4) · RTTNews: Scotts Q4 loss narrows, FY27 guidance (Nov 4)

DEMAND

### MetroScape Landscape, a commercial maintenance company founded in 1990 in Irving, Texas, said October 28 that its new local owners plan to invest in employees, technology and operating systems.

**Why it matters:** Dr. Marc Nickell and Chris Brewer, who previously led business services company Rocket Station, bought MetroScape in March 2026; the price was not disclosed. MetroScape serves office, multifamily, retail and other commercial properties across Dallas-Fort Worth and offers maintenance, irrigation management and landscape enhancements. Owners bidding commercial maintenance in Dallas-Fort Worth compete with it. If you hold commercial contracts, list each renewal date and send your 2027 service proposal at least 90 days ahead.

MetroScape Landscape owners release (PR Newswire, Oct 28)

## POOL

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

### Hayward raised its 2026 net sales growth outlook to about 5% to 6% on October 28 after third-quarter sales rose 6% to $260.1 million, with North America up 9%.

**Why it matters:** Hayward said North America sales rose 9% to $226.4 million while Europe and Rest of World fell 6% to $33.8 million. The release says net price increases helped drive sales growth. Adjusted EPS guidance rose to $0.86 to $0.88 from $0.84 to $0.87, and net leverage was 1.5 times at September 26. Ask your Hayward distributor in writing whether a 2027 price notice is coming, and put a 30-day expiry on replacement-equipment quotes until you know.

Hayward Q3 2026 results release (SEC 8-K, Oct 28)

DEMAND

### Shasta Pools, a 60-year-old company, was sold to an ownership group of Dansons Capital, Accrual Equity Partners and Hydro Construction, and its new owners say the three-year-old service division will be the foundation for expansion.

**Why it matters:** Pool & Spa News reported November 4 that the Ast family, which founded Shasta, announced the sale in late summer. Vic Harshman, with 30-plus years in pool construction in Arizona, Nevada and Texas, heads residential construction. The service division launched three years ago, and the owners say acquisitions are "not our primary focus." If you run a service route, update a one-page list of customer counts, monthly rates and cancellations so you can answer a buyer's first questions in a day.

Pool & Spa News: Shasta Pools expansion (Nov 4)

## APPLIANCE REPAIR

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

### Whirlpool said on its October 27 call it will raise prices a further 7%, effective November 1 in Canada and December 3 in the United States, and put third-quarter North American industry demand down 3.3%.

**Why it matters:** CEO Marc Bitzer said Whirlpool has also implemented pricing actions of 7% to 10% in North America and Latin America. The company expects the North American industry to fall about 5% for 2026, which Bitzer said is "largely coming off discretionary," and said "we're living right now in a replacement market." Update your repair-versus-replace worksheet with new-unit prices before December 3, and add a written replacement price range to every repair estimate above your own threshold.

Whirlpool Q3 2026 earnings call transcript (Oct 27)

SUPPLY

### CPSC announced November 5 that Gourmia is recalling about 175,951 nine-slice digital air fryer ovens after 57 reports of doors closing unexpectedly and 40 burn incidents.

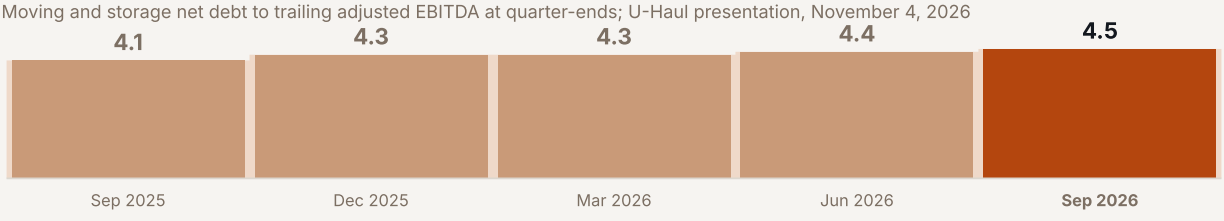
**Why it matters:** The GTF7530 ovens sold at Target stores and Target.com from October 2021 through June 2026 for about $150. CPSC says consumers should contact Gourmia for a free repair kit by mail; the recall number is 27-069. Customers may call you first. Add the model number to your intake script, tell callers the fix is a free mail-in kit, and decline paid work on recalled units until the kit is installed.

CPSC: Gourmia recalls air fryer ovens (Nov 5)

INFOGRAPHIC 3 / TRUCK RENTAL LEVERAGE

**U-Haul's moving and storage net debt rose from 4.1 times adjusted EBITDA in September 2025 to 4.5 times in September 2026.**

Moving and storage net debt to trailing adjusted EBITDA at quarter-ends; U-Haul presentation, November 4, 2026




Total debt rose from $7.73 billion to $8.27 billion while trailing adjusted EBITDA went from $1.68 billion to $1.64 billion. U-Haul is the do-it-yourself rental alternative your customers price against. U-Haul 2Q27 investor presentation (Nov 4)

## MOVING

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

### U-Haul's moving and storage revenue rose $61.3 million to $1,694.2 million in the quarter ended September 30, with self-moving equipment rental revenue up 3.4% to $1,147.9 million.

**Why it matters:** U-Haul reported November 4 that in-town transactions increased and revenue per transaction rose in both in-town and one-way markets. It said it increased the number of box trucks in its rental fleet, which it puts at about 205,600 trucks. These are do-it-yourself rental figures. Price three typical routes against a U-Haul rental quote this week, and put the crew-labor difference in writing on your estimates.

U-Haul Q2 FY2027 results release (SEC 8-K, Nov 4)

DEMAND

### U-Haul's same-store self-storage occupancy fell to 89.5% from 90.6% a year earlier while revenue per occupied foot rose to $18.99 from $17.80, its November 4 presentation shows.

**Why it matters:** Across its owned portfolio of 1,652 stores and 645,023 units, average monthly occupancy for the quarter was 74.2%, against 76.3% a year earlier. U-Haul's definitions of occupancy and revenue per foot are its own. If you rent warehouse or storage space to customers, calculate your September occupancy and revenue per occupied foot in the same terms and compare.

U-Haul 2Q27 investor presentation (Nov 4)

THE BACKGROUND SIGNAL

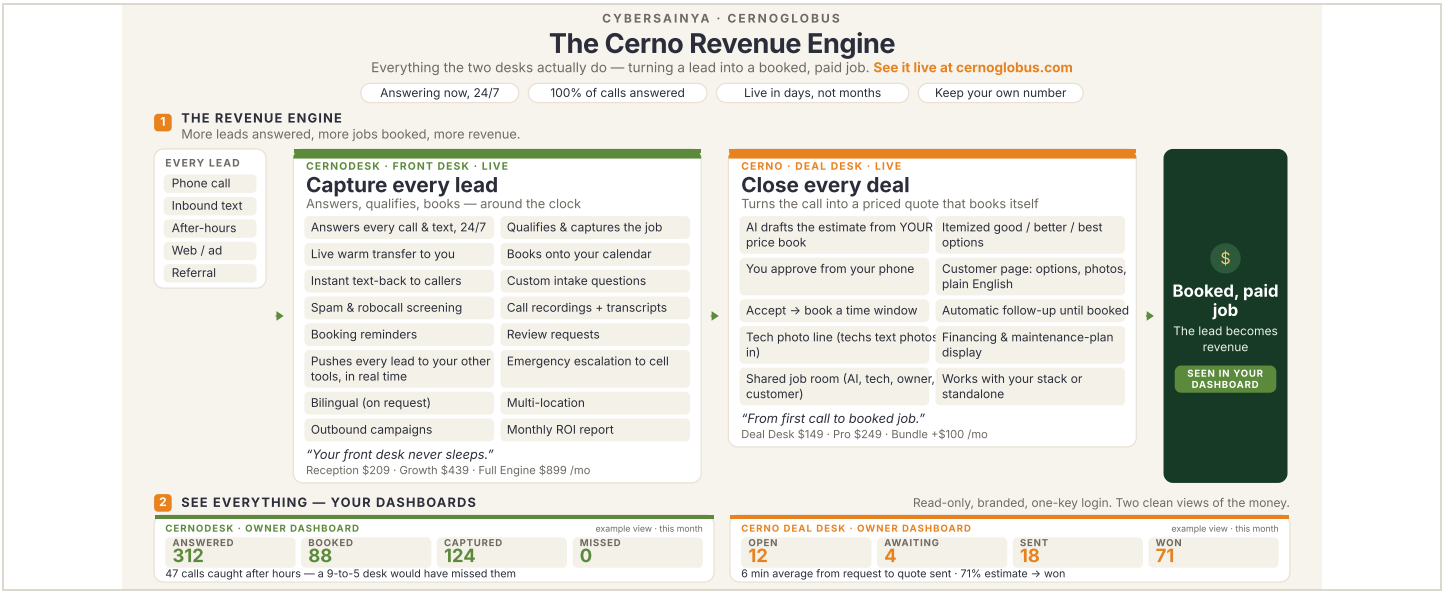
## The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center took 24,768 business email compromise reports in 2025, with losses of $3.05 billion — a record, after dipping to $2.77 billion in 2024 from $2.95 billion in 2023. Across all internet crime it logged 1,008,597 complaints and $20.88 billion in losses. Reported cases only, so read it as a floor.

Business email compromise, not ransomware, is the one that should concern a home services operator. Someone gets into a mailbox, reads until they understand how you invoice and who pays you, then sends a real-looking progress billing with different bank details. No malware, no warning — just a payment that never arrives and an argument about who eats it. A trade that emails estimates, service tickets and supplier invoices all day is the shape this is built for. The quieter number is adoption: under 20% of firms with fewer than 20 staff use AI at all.

**What to do about it:** You don't need a security program. You need multi-factor authentication on email and your accounting login, and one rule everybody follows: nobody changes bank details on the strength of an email or a call — you ring the number you already had on file and confirm. That covers most of it, and costs nothing. The part it doesn't — how the systems are set up — is the day job of our parent company, CyberSainya.

FBI Internet Crime Complaint Center, 2025 Internet Crime Report — reported cases only, rounded from $2,946,830,270, $2,770,151,146 and $3,046,598,558. U.S. Census Bureau, Business Trends and Outlook Survey, May 3, 2026.




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